

Best Ball Butts 2026: Week 3 outlook

As of 2026-09-24. Weeks 1–2 are final and locked in; Week 3 kicks off tonight. The numbers are the average of 12 season simulations (6 projection sources × 2 noise models, 8,000 seasons each) on the real schedule, best-ball scoring and Sleeper's 6-team bracket.

TL;DR

- **No new week has completed since the last edition** (still Weeks 1–2 locked, Week 3 not yet played), so every number below is unchanged from the same-day prior edition — this run refreshes injury sourcing and re-verifies the data rather than moving the odds.
- **Noelle remains the favorite at 25.8%**, 1st in 8 of 12 runs and never worse than 2nd. She still leads with the record removed (23.0%), so her edge comes from roster strength, not a lucky start.
- **Raghav is 2nd at 20.6%**, 2-0 with 50.6% bye odds and 1st under ESPN and market, the sources that rate Allen and Chase highest. Then a gap: Ben 13.9%, Emma 13.7%, Henry 9.9%, Lauren 7.9%, Conrad 6.6%, Avery 1.6% (last in all 12 runs).

Standings odds

#	Manager	Rec	PF	Title %	Range	Playoff %	Bye %	Prior edition (Sep 23)	Δ
1	Noelle	2-0	395.0	25.8	15–32	96.6	58.9	25.8	+0.0
2	Raghav	2-0	351.9	20.6	15–30	95.1	50.6	20.6	+0.0
3	Ben	1-1	372.8	13.9	10–21	87.3	29.6	13.9	+0.0
4	Emma	1-1	390.1	13.7	8–19	84.6	23.5	13.7	+0.0
5	Henry	0-2	334.4	9.9	6–12	69.7	11.5	9.9	+0.0
6	Lauren	2-0	400.3	7.9	6–13	78.5	17.1	7.9	+0.0
7	Conrad	0-2	301.9	6.6	3–10	58.2	7.0	6.6	+0.0
8	Avery	0-2	336.6	1.6	1–3	30.0	1.7	1.6	+0.0

What changed since the last edition

- **Nothing on the field:** the prior edition was produced a few hours earlier the same evening, Weeks 1–2 results are unchanged and Week 3 hasn't kicked off, so records, PF and every engine's title odds are identical to the last run.
- **One injury note firmed up:** Nico Collins (Henry, hamstring) is now reported as unlikely to play Week 3 vs. Indianapolis — a second straight missed game — rather than a straight coin flip; still tagged as day-to-day with no structural issue.
- **Everything else re-checked, unchanged:** Puka Nacua (Conrad), Aaron Jones (Raghav) and Sam Darnold (Noelle) are still legitimate Week 3 game-time decisions with no fresh word — Seattle has said it will decide on Darnold by Friday. Lauren is still down to Hurts alone at QB after Jaxson Dart's season-ending knee surgery, and Henry's receiving corps (Reed, A.J. Brown, Njoku, Goedert, Collins) is still the league's most injury-hit group.

Team by team

- **Noelle (25.8%):** 2-0 on 395.0 points and ahead on paper in 11 of her 12 remaining games. Daniels (out Weeks 3–5) and Pierce are hurt, but they were her depth, not her core.
- **Raghav (20.6%):** 2-0, but the lowest scorer of the three unbeaten teams. Josh Allen (39.7, 46.8) carries a WR room that ranks 7th of 8. Week 7 vs Noelle (Allen on bye) is the danger game.
- **Ben (13.9%):** the quiet riser. The league's best best-ball converter, with a league-high 214.8 in Week 2. His Week 10 and 14 byes land in the seeding stretch.
- **Emma (13.7%):** still the deepest backfield, with the WR room still last. She gave back Week 1's windfall and swapped an injured Caleb Williams for Tyler Shough.
- **Henry (9.9%):** 0-2 with the league's most injury flags (Reed, A.J. Brown, Njoku, Goedert, Collins), but still one of the biggest point piles on paper. The hits all fall early, and he projects as a top-three weekly scorer in Weeks 11–14.
- **Lauren (7.9%):** 2-0 with the most points (400.3), but Dart's season-ending injury leaves her one QB deep, so Week 10 is empty at QB and Week 13 empty at RB. The record is carrying a 7th-place roster.
- **Conrad (6.6%):** the unluckiest 0-2 (301.9 PF, last by 32.6). Every engine rates his roster above Lauren's; the record, not the roster, drops him to 7th.

- **Avery (1.6%):** last in all 12 runs. His QBs are a strength, but his RB/TE starters are the league's worst, and he's the underdog on paper in all 12 remaining games.

Data checks

- **D/ST scoring:** all 24 defense scores in Weeks 1–2 are non-zero and match a recount from Sleeper's raw stats (0 mismatches, 0 zero scores).
- **Data source:** rosters, byes and projections came through Raghav's gateway MCP (sleeper-draft__export_league_snapshot, sha256-verified) — the direct-API fallback was not used.
- **Caveats:** rosters are frozen from here (no waivers or trades), and Week 3 injury coin-flips are scored as out (Nacua, Aaron Jones, Collins, Darnold).